

## Trump joins the global Jewish conspiracy



(official White House photo)



It bears repeating that Donald Trump's rationale for war against Iran keeps shifting because [Trump himself does not believe his own rationales](#). The goal of this war has little to do with Iran. It has to do with creating conditions in which an old, depleted and unpopular president looks [big, tough and loved on American TV](#).

But there may be a reason outside the president's fear of defeat in this year's congressional elections. While he believes that he benefits from the perception of being a war president, it looks like the decision to become one wasn't entirely his to make.

[Early reporting](#) on the war suggested that Israel was going to attack Iran without or without [Trump](#), and that Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu was lobbying him to join the effort. [USA Today reported yesterday](#) that Netanyahu decided in November of last year to order a long-planned operation to assassinate Iran's Supreme Leader Ayatollah Ali Khamenei.

Marco Rubio [confirmed that reporting](#) on Monday: "We knew that there was going to be an Israeli action. We knew that that would precipitate an attack against American forces, and we knew that if we didn't preemptively go after them before they launched those attacks, we would suffer higher casualties."

Just so I have this straight in my mind: Trump did not attack Iran in order to stop it from having nukes; in order to stop it from being a global leader in state-sponsored terrorism; in order to liberate the Iranian people; or in order to manifest world peace.

no, the president launched an illegal and unjustified war with Iran because America's ally, Israel, put him in a no-win situation in which, as [one source told](#) the *Post* over the weekend, "the only debate that seemed to be remaining was whether the US would launch in concert with Israel or if the US would wait until Iran retaliated on US military targets in the region and then engage."

Trump could have condemned Netanyahu after the fact, but apparently the appeal of being a war president was too great.

If I were the commander-in-chief of the world's mightiest military, and if I allowed a foreign head of state to lead me around by the nose, I would also come up with a couple dozen reasons for going to war with Iran, no matter how unconvincing those reasons may be, because I would be highly motivated to draw attention away from the view that I'm not entirely in charge.

I mean, Trump can't even take credit for Khamenei's death. Pete Hegseth told reporters the [Israeli strikes killed him Saturday](#). The only "credit" he can claim is having followed Netanyahu's lead.

That it appears the decision to attack Iran was Netanyahu's more than it was Trump's is going to be a problem, most immediately because of the outcry in the Congress. If Trump was not acting in self-defense, and clearly he was not, then this war against Iran is a war of choice, which requires the consent of the Congress.

Trump is going to be forced to explain himself, thus risking being held accountable for the spike in [goods](#) and [oil prices](#), Tuesday's [sell-off on Wall Street](#) and general chaos in the Middle East.

Bahrain, Egypt, Gaza, Iran, Iraq, Israel, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Oman, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Syria, UAE, West Bank and Yemen.” NBC News [reported](#) that the mandatory orders are coming despite many airports in the region being shuttered. In Qatar, Americans who can’t get out were advised that “[should not rely on the US government for assisted departure or evacuation.](#)”)

The White House’s *best* rationale for war seems to be that the US was forced to attack Iran, because Iran was forced to defend itself against Israel’s attack. Such a rationale is not going to fly with most of the Congress, including many maga Republicans. That’s why Trump lied Tuesday. He said Netanyahu didn’t force my hand. I forced his. [According to](#) Kaitlan Collins, he said “it was his opinion that Iran was going to attack first if the US didn’t.”

For the lie to work, however, he needs the full faith of maga. He needs the base to trust him enough to play along. To do that, he must affirm his dominance. If supporters believe he’s Netanyahu’s puppet, however, such displays of dominance will seem empty and hollow to his own people, thus creating problems much bigger than abstract debates in the Congress over war powers.

To understand the problem he has created for himself, bear in mind the true nature of America First, which has been largely sanitized by the Washington press corps. It is not rooted in high-minded principles like freedom and national sovereignty. It is rooted in conspiracy theory and antisemitism, which are often provided a veneer of respectability by rightwing intellectuals

and gullible reporters. Peel away the noble-sounding language, however, about nation-builders “intervening in complex societies that they did not even understand themselves,” as [Trump said](#) last year, and what you find at the center of America First is an unshakeable belief in a global Jewish conspiracy against America.

This belief in a global Jewish conspiracy against America was the foundation beneath the push to release the Epstein files during Trump’s 2024 campaign. The belief took on a slightly different form, but the animus was the same. Trump was supposed to have been the hero sent by God to fulfill a prophecy to save America from a secret cabal of powerful Jews who sex-trafficked young girls to untouchable elites. In maga lore, Jeffrey Epstein came to represent this shadowy, malevolent syndicate. Once reelected, Trump was supposed to bring them all to justice. When he didn’t, he [triggered a crisis of faith](#) that can be registered in recent polling that lumps him in with the rest of the “[wealthy elites](#)” who act with impunity for the law – the so-called “[Epstein class](#).”

The [Times reported Tuesday](#) on the growing uproar within the maga movement over the possibility that Netanyahu said “jump” and Trump asked “how high?” Some of the most invested maga personalities, men like Jack Posobiec, told the *Times* that divisions can be overcome and lingering doubts will only be relevant to future candidates to lead the maga movement.



Supporters could shift from anti-war to pro-war as seamlessly as Trump does. But what Posobiec is ignoring, because it's in his interest to ignore it, is that America First is not rooted in high-minded principles. It's rooted in Jew-hate. Supporters are not going to warm up to the appearance of an American president seeming to take orders from the leader of a Jewish state. Instead, they might see Trump doing to believers in America First what he has done to supporters who demanded the release of the Epstein files.

Again, this is why the president lied Tuesday. In an attempt to assert dominance, he said *he was the one* to force Netanyahu's hand, not the other way around. That might have worked – the base might have trusted him enough to play along with the lie – but for his already established betrayal in the Epstein case. With Iran, he has now compounded maga's crisis of faith. He must contend with the growing suspicion that instead of destroying the global Jewish conspiracy against America, he has joined it.



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